HUTCHINSON HIGH SCHOOL

Home of the Salthawks

Office of the Principal | Hutchinson, Kansas

September 2004

Dear Class of 2005,

What's up, Salthawks? Welcome back to your senior year, the big one. Before anything else, mark your calendar for Homecoming. Do not miss it. The band is warming up, Student Council has big plans for the gym, and I have a feeling it's going to be a night to remember. Come early, stay late, and help stack chairs when it's over.

I know you've got a million things going on, like updating your away message, burning the perfect mix CD, and squeezing one more text out of that flip phone. Still, make time to cheer loud on Friday nights, pack the house for the Thespians' spring play, and keep the FFA barn smelling the way it always has. Whether you're band, ball, robotics, theater, ag, student government, or part of the crowd out by the back lot, you're all part of this class, and this class is going to be remembered.

The year moves fast in Kansas. Fall brings Homecoming, college applications, and scholarship essays, so start early. Winter will test your patience and your windshield scraper. By spring the talk turns to prom, tornado drills, and what comes after June, and I hope every one of you has a few good options on the table. Then comes graduation, when the whole town fills the stadium to cheer you on.

Real talk: graduation is the starting line for whatever you build next. Everything you've done in these halls gets you ready for it, and I can't wait to see what each of you does with it.

A couple of reminders from the front office:

- Swing by the counseling office early, ask plenty of questions, and read the fine print before you say yes to anything.
- Look out for each other. If a buddy seems off, say something.
- Keep your eyes and ears open. You'd be surprised what a person picks up out here under that big sky.
- Be home when the sirens go off, and be at school when the bell rings.

Whatever comes next, remember where you started. The salt beneath our feet is older than any of us, and this town has stood on it through every storm. So can you.

Stay cool, stay curious, and I'll see you at the game Friday.

Go Salthawks,

Dale Hargrove ("Mr. H" to those who've earned it)
Principal, Hutchinson High School